

3. Project scaffolding:

"I want to build a small CLI to-do app in Python.

1. Suggest a feature list for an MVP.
2. Propose a file structure.
3. Help me implement it step-by-step – only move on when the previous step runs."

Over time you can graduate to using tools like GitHub Copilot or IDE copilots for inline suggestions, but ChatGPT/Gemini remain your explanation layer.

Language learning: AI as conversation partner and grammar coach

LLMs are surprisingly good language partners:

1. Set the rules:

"You are my [Spanish/Japanese/German/etc.] tutor.

- Talk to me only in [language], unless I ask for English.
- If I make a mistake, echo my sentence with corrections and a short, friendly explanation.
- Keep sentences simple at first; gradually increase difficulty as I improve."

2. Daily chat (10–15 minutes):

- Talk about your day, plans, favourite food, news.
- Ask AI to introduce new vocabulary around topics you like (gaming, travel, tech).

3. Micro-drills:

"Give me 10 sentences where I must choose the correct verb conjugation and then tell me the answer with explanation."

4. Role-play:

"Role-play a restaurant conversation in [language].

You are the waiter; I'm the customer.

Increase difficulty slowly and correct me as we go."

Apps like Duolingo are integrating generative AI too, but a generic LLM is flexible enough to design exactly the kind of practice you want.

Soft skills: explanations, presentations, and communication

Want to improve explaining tech to non-tech people, or presenting ideas clearly?

Practice explaining:

"I need to explain [technical concept] to a non-technical stakeholder in 3 minutes.

1. Write a simple explanation with an analogy.
2. Then play the role of that stakeholder and ask me 3 questions.
3. Critique my answers and suggest how I can improve clarity."

Practice presentations:

1. Ask AI to outline your talk:

"Create a 5-slide outline for a 10-minute presentation on [topic] for [audience type]."

2. Then:

"Now pretend you are my audience and ask 3 tough questions about this presentation."

3. Answer those aloud, then paste your answers back and ask AI for feedback on structure, clarity and tone.

There are even AI tools that specialise in public speaking coaching – some analyse your voice & pacing, others give feedback on filler words – but you can get a surprising amount of mileage from a plain LLM.

4. AI-supported mock interviews and resume editing

Skill goals often tie into career upgrades: new job, promotion, domain switch. AI can help with the unglamorous part – resumes, cover letters, and interview practice.

Resume optimisation (without turning into a robot)

There are dedicated AI resume tools such as Careerflow, AIApply, and Teal, which help tailor resumes to job descriptions and improve ATS-friendliness.

At a minimum, you can use ChatGPT/Gemini like this:

"Here is a job description:

[paste JD]

Here is my current resume:

[paste resume]

1. Summarise what this job seems to value most (skills, experiences, keywords).
2. Suggest specific bullet-level changes to my resume to better align with this, without lying.
3. Rewrite my summary/profile section in 3 different styles:
 - Conservative corporate
 - Crisp and impact-focused
 - Slightly more creative but still professional."

Important: Recent reporting shows some candidates are using aggressive "AI resume hacks" to game ATS systems – stuffing keywords, hiding text, etc. – but that can create ethical issues and backfire. Use AI to clarify and highlight your real value, not fake it.

Mock interview practice with LLMs and dedicated tools

There's a whole category of AI interview helpers now – tools like Final Round AI, Interview Warmup (Google), and others that generate questions, record your answers and give feedback.

Even without those, you can turn ChatGPT/Gemini into a surprisingly good interviewer.

"Act as an interviewer for the role of [Job Title] at a [company type/domain].

- Ask me one question at a time.
- Wait for my answer.